according to Zaidi (2013) the media hype around the role of social media has been vastly overplayed and most of the debate on change took place within a social media bubble that bore little resemblance to reality.

The British Council research on how the young generation felt before the 2013 elections found that on aggregate young people in Pakistan were very pessimistic. The main issues remained inflation, lack of employment opportunities and issues pertaining to security and violence. Most importantly the youth reported very low confidence in official institutions, in particular the government, parliament and political parties, reflecting research by Lall (2012) and Yusuf (2011) and showing that attitudes had not changed much when it comes to government institutions.[13] While disillusionment with the previous five years certainly played a part in these opinions, one could also argue that the lack of understanding as to how the system works is largely at fault. This is reflected in the crux of the problem, which remains voter registration. The pre-election survey by the BC showed that only around 40 per cent of the young definitely planned to vote on the day.[14] Of those who definitely did not plan to vote, 29 per cent were not registered and 5 per cent did not have a national identity card. Another 19 per cent did not believe that the elections would make a difference and 13 per cent did not like the political parties or candidates.[15] Overall in the BC survey there is little difference between urban and rural responses, except that in rural areas the number of those not voting because they are not registered or do not have a national identity card goes up to 41 per cent and 7 per cent respectively.[16] This is despite the fact that the CNIC (computerized national identity card) process has made voter registration so much easier.[17] On the day of the elections 16.88 million of the 85.42 million registered voters were aged under 26, and 12.73 million were aged under 30, that is, the total number of young people voting represented 34 per cent of registered voters (Haider 2013).[18] Actual voter turnout was 55.02 per cent (i.e. 44.8 million voters). According to the Gallup exit polls (2013) 11.2 million voters (25 per cent) were from the 18–29 age group; however, we do not know exactly how many young people actually cast their vote. It looks like their turnout was proportionately smaller than that of other age groups, defying the media hype.[19]

Even if (according to the BC research) there are few differences between the attitudes of urban and rural youths, it is likely that there are stark differences between social classes. A random selection of thirty-three youths from working class and poor backgrounds in a Karachi slum and in a poor area in semi-urban/rural Punjab in December 2012 had shown that although all who took part in the